



Refugee Week

Coordinated by
Refugee Council of Australia

REFUGEE WEEK 2026



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HUNTER NEW ENGLAND
AND CENTRAL COAST

An Australian Government Initiative

**PRIMARY
HEALTH
NETWORK**

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Welcome Message	1
About Mosaic	2
2026 Theme - A Million Stories	3
Why people seek safety	5
Definitions of refugees and asylum seekers	6
Facts about Refugees	8
Health Challenges	12
Barriers to healthcare	13
Translation and Interpreting Service	14
Health Services	16
Films on Refugees	17
Books on Refugees	19
Podcasts on Refugees	20

WELCOME MESSAGE



We would like to acknowledge the traditional custodian of the land we are on, the Darkinjung land, and pay our respects to the elders of past and present, this land was and will always be, Aboriginal land



OVERVIEW

For over 45 years, Mosaic Multicultural Connections (Mosaic) has walked alongside multicultural communities across Newcastle, the Hunter, Lake Macquarie, Central Coast, New England and North West regions, honouring every unique journey.

Through settlement, family, youth, aged care and community development programs, we witness daily the strength and resilience of the people we serve. When families find their footing in a new home, when elders receive care that respects their traditions, when young people thrive.

Every story, every contribution, every act of courage makes our communities richer and stronger together. These moments reinforce the purpose and reflect the true impact of our work.

OUR VISION

A community where diversity defines and nourishes us.

OUR MISSION

To support and inspire culturally diverse people and communities to overcome barriers and thrive



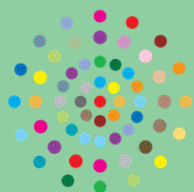
2026 THEME – A MILLION STORIES

As Europe recovered from the devastation of World War II, Australia responded to an international call to offer a future to people with nowhere to call home. Since that initial agreement in 1947 to receive 4000 refugees from Central Europe, Australia has issued one million permanent humanitarian visas – welcoming people from all parts of the globe, people who have helped to build modern Australia.

Refugee Week 2026 is a moment to reflect on that milestone and to celebrate the million stories behind it. Each story is unique. Each one is powerful. And together, they shape the Australia we all call home today.

This is about more than a number. One person's journey influences the lives of many others: children, grandchildren, and future generations who leave their unique mark on our shared story. A thread in something greater; a million colourful strands woven into a rich and beautiful tapestry, shaping communities and stories we continue to tell.

As we celebrate this milestone, we also look to the future.



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A Million Stories

14 – 20 June 2026



refugeeweek.org.au | #RefugeeWeekAU



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For equality
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FIND OUT MORE ABOUT
REFUGEE WEEK



Thu-Trang, a former refugee from Vietnam, with her two children. Discover her story at refugeeweek.org.au. Photo by Attie Moheballi.



WHY PEOPLE SEEK SAFETY



Armed conflict and wars

Millions flee to escape active war zones, bombings, and general violence. Major recent drivers include conflicts in Syria, Ukraine, Afghanistan, South Sudan, and Venezuela.

- USA for UNHCR

Persecution and Human Rights Violations

Many are targeted because of who they are, what they believe, or their affiliations, including: race/nationality, religion, political opinions, membership in a particular social group.

-Amnesty Internaional, Australia

Violence and insecurity

Political unrest may cause violence and danger for the communities; gang violence, sexual and gender-based violence, arbitrary detention or torture are reasons for people to seek safety.

-Amnesty International Australia



DEFINITIONS – REFUGEES AND ASYLUM SEEKERS

Who is a Refugee?

A refugee is someone who has been forced to flee their country due to war, violence, or persecution and has been granted protection under international law.

Who is an Asylum Seeker?

An asylum seeker is someone who has applied for refugee protection but is still waiting for their claim to be assessed.



KEY DIFFERENCE



Refugees

- Have been officially recognised as needing protection
- Often have access to more support services
- Have legal status in the country

Asylum Seekers

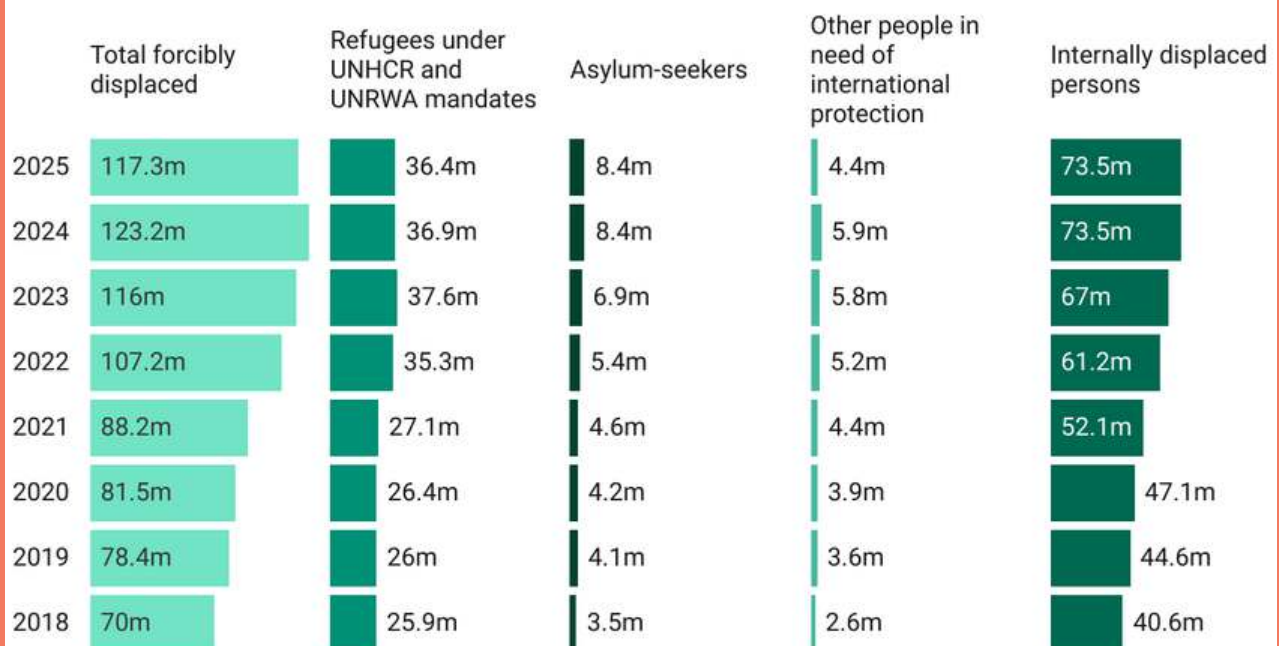
- Awaiting the decision their application
- May have limited access to services
- Legal status is temporary or uncertain



FACTS ABOUT REFUGEES

How many refugees are there in the world?

Numbers of people (in millions), as at 30 June 2025



Figures for 2025 are for 30 June 2025, and are an estimate subject to variation. For a detailed explanation of the different population groups, see <https://www.unhcr.org/refugee-statistics/insights/explainers/forcibly-displaced-pops.html>. Note that the total forcibly displaced in 2023 and 2024 does not equal the total number of the constituent groups because, according to UNHCR, 'at the end of 2023, UNRWA estimates that 70 per cent of the 1.7 million IDPs in the Gaza Strip at end-2023 were Palestine refugees under its mandate. These internally displaced refugees under UNRWA's mandate are only counted once in the global forcibly displaced total.'

Chart: Refugee Council of Australia • Source: United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees, Refugee Data Finder, Forcibly displaced population • Created with Datawrapper



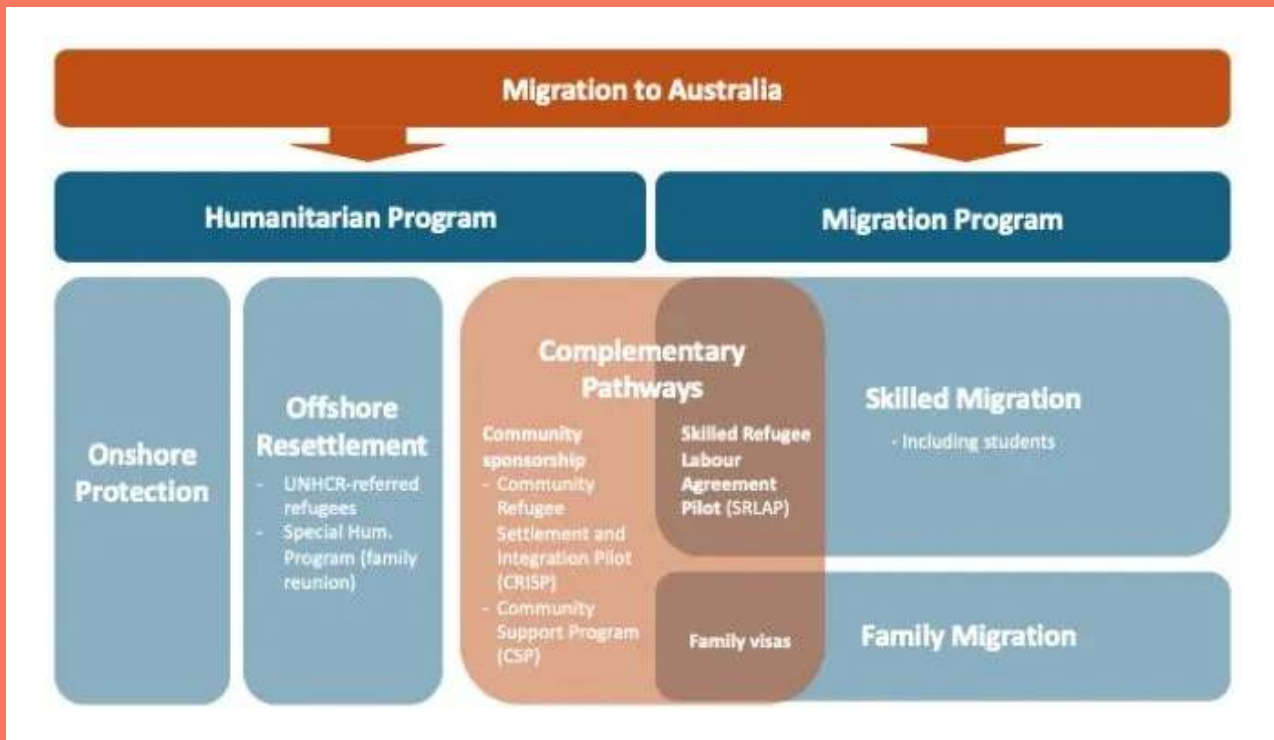
FACTS ABOUT REFUGEES

The United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees reports that although global refugee numbers reached 36.6 million by mid-2025, key patterns have remained consistent over time. Most refugees are hosted by low- and middle-income countries (around 71%), often in nations close to their home countries, and many remain displaced for long periods. Despite having limited resources, low-income countries host a disproportionately large share of refugees compared to their population and economic capacity, while high-income countries—though wealthier—host a smaller proportion overall.

-UNHCR: The UN Refugee Agency



MIGRATION PATHWAYS TO AUSTRALIA



Refugee Council of Australia

Australia has been resettling refugees with permanent visas through an offshore program since the 1970s, primarily referred by the UN Refugee Agency (UNHCR). Refugees may also be eligible for a Special Humanitarian Program visa (subclass 202) if they have a proposer in Australia and meet eligibility requirements. The government determines the annual number of visas granted, as well as the countries and cases given priority.



Refugees and People Seeking Asylum

Stats
& Facts

A **person seeking asylum** is someone who has left their home country and is seeking protection elsewhere but whose refugee claim has not yet been determined.

A **refugee** is a person who has fled their home country due to persecution, war or violence. Under the Refugee Convention, refugees have a well-founded fear of persecution based on race, religion, nationality, political opinion or membership of a particular social group. They are granted refugee status and special protections.

Everyone has the right to seek asylum and be protected from serious harm, no matter how they arrive in another country. These rights are protected by international law.

Since the end of World War II, **Australia** has welcomed nearly

1 million

refugees and others in humanitarian need.¹



As at mid-2023,

110 million
people

were **forcibly displaced** as a result of **conflict** or **persecution**.



62.5 million

are displaced within their own countries

36.4 million

are recognised as refugees awaiting resettlement

6.1 million

are **seeking asylum** in another country²



Most people seeking asylum don't come by boat ³



In the 10 years to December 2023,

49 boats
arrived

in Australia, with a total of **1114 people** on board.⁴

In the 10 years to December 2022, Australia recognised or resettled

180,073
refugees. ⁵

This was **less than 1%** of all asylum applications made globally.⁵



The top 3 source countries for humanitarian arrivals to Australia in 2022 - 2023 were:

Afghanistan: 8,045

Iraq: 2,108

Myanmar: 1,902 ⁶



Australian Human
Rights Commission

Suggested citation: Australian Human Rights Commission. (2025). Stats & Facts: Refugees and People Seeking Asylum

2025





HEALTH CHALLENGES

Refugees and asylum seekers experience complex health challenges due to difficult conditions before, during, and after seeking safety. These challenges include both physical and mental health issues. They are often linked to trauma, limited healthcare access, and resettlement difficulties.

Physical health challenges may include untreated chronic illnesses (such as diabetes and hypertension), infectious diseases, poor nutrition, and fatigue.

Mental health challenges are also common, including trauma, post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD), anxiety, depression, grief, and social isolation. These issues are frequently linked to experiences of war, displacement, loss, and ongoing stress in a new environment.

Overall, these health challenges are often interconnected and may be worsened by social factors such as loneliness, financial hardship, and barriers to healthcare access.



BARRIERS TO HEALTHCARE



Refugees and
asylum seekers
may face the
following barriers
when seek
healthcare

**LANGUAGE
BARRIERS**

**CULTURAL
DIFFERENCE**

**LACK OF
KNOWLEDGE ABOUT
THE HEALTH SYSTEM**

**FINANCIAL
CONSTRAINTS**

**FEAR OR
UNCERTAINTY ABOUT
LEGAL STATUS**



Translation and Interpreting Service National

The Translating and Interpreting Service (TIS National) plays a vital role in helping people communicate when they don't speak English confidently. In a multicultural country like Australia, clear communication is essential—especially in healthcare, legal, and community settings.

TIS National provides interpreters in over 150 languages through phone, video, and in-person services, ensuring important information is understood. Some services are free for eligible organisations, making it easier to support diverse communities.



In a multicultural country like Australia, clear communication is essential—especially in healthcare, legal, and community settings.



TIS for Non-English Speakers:

- Provides interpreting via phone, video, and in-person
- Immediate phone interpreting is available 24/7 by calling **131 450**
- Offers pre-booked phone, on-site, and video interpreting services
- Users need to provide basic details (name, organisation, contact number)
- TIS ensure clear communication in important situations like healthcare and government services
- Free Translation Translating Services: Free translation of up to 10 personal documents
- Easy online application with a 2-year account access
- Translations usually completed within 30 days by professional (often NAATI-accredited) translators
- Free corrections within 30 days and a secure, government-standard system

**Immediate
phone
interpreting is
available 24/7
by calling
131 450.**



Learn more
about TIS





HEALTH SERVICES

CCLHD Community Health Centres



NSW Refugee Health Service



Women's Health NSW



Health Direct



Health and Interpretation

NSW Healthcare Interpreting Services



In-Language Health Resources (find information in your language)



FILMS ON REFUGEES

Three Songs of Benzair (2022)

In a camp for displaced people in Kabul, this film wrestles with matters of love, separation, choices, consequences, and the human need for safety.

Captains of Zaatari (2021, Ali El Arabi)

A prominent sports academy arrives at Za'atari refugee camp in Jordan. Two close friends, connected by their aspirations and hopes of playing football have the opportunity to bring their dreams to fruition.

Limbo (2020, Ben Sharrock)

A tragicomic take on the experience of Syrian refugees, this comedy drama centres on four people seeking asylum on a remote island in Scotland.



FILMS ON REFUGEES

Flee (2021, Jonas Poher Rasmussen)

A musician, Amin Nawabi is a refugee from Afghanistan. We hear of his migration journey from Afghanistan to Denmark as a child refugee.

The Merger (2018, Mark Grentell)

When a football club is unable to fill all its positions, they work with a refugee centre to encourage refugees to live in the small town.

Frontiers of Dreams and Fears (2001, Mai Masri)

This film tells the heartbreaking story of two young Palestinian girls growing up in refugee camps in Beirut and Bethlehem. The film focuses on the friendship of two young girls, their daily life, their dreams, hopes and aspirations.





BOOKS ON REFUGEES

Children's and Young Adult Books

- **Boy Overboard** (Morris Gleitzman, 2002)
- **The Little refugee** (Anh Do, 2011)
- **Mina and the whole wide world** (Sherryl Clark, 2021)
- **When the stars are scattered** (Victoria Jamieson, 2020)
- **Other words for home** (Jasmine Warge, 2021)
- **The otherside of tommorow** (Tina Cho, 2024)

Adult books and Non-fiction

- **The power of hope: how community, love & compassion can change our world** (Kon Karapanagiotidis, 2018)
- **The Mires** (Tina Makereti, 2024)
- **The Lost Boy: Tales of a child soldier** (Ayik Chut Deng, 2020)
- **The Kabul peace house** (Mark Issacs, 2019)
- **In The Midst of Winter** (Isabel Allende, 2017)
- **The Lucky Ones** (Melinda Ham, 2024)
- **Between Us** (Clare Aktins, 2018)
- **Safe haven** (Shankari Chandran, 2024)



PODCASTS ON REFUGEES

Belonging
and Beyond



New Home
(SBS)



Forced to Flee,
UNHCR

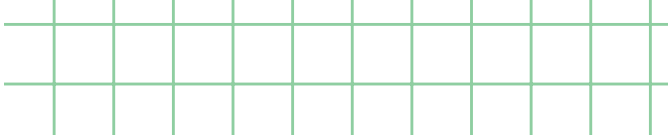


In My Country



The Messenger





REFUGEE SUPPORT SERVICES



Agencies in NSW for everyday needs, health, financial assistance, housing, legal issues, and social activities



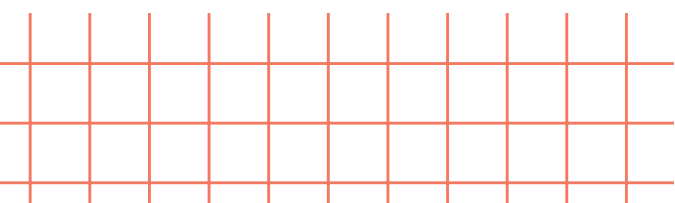
Amnesty International Australia



Settlement Services International - Regional

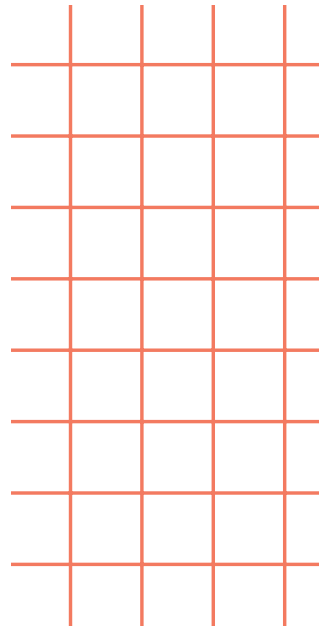


STARTTS: NSW Service for the Treatment and Rehabilitation of Torture and Trauma Survivors





mosaic
multicultural connections



This service is supported by funding from

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